

7/17/2026

Subham Khatua

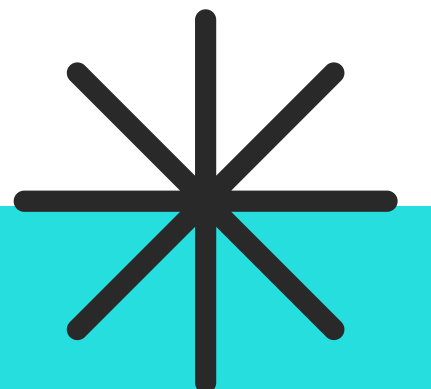
PHISHING ATTACKS: SPOTTING AND STOPPING SCAMS

Protect Yourself from Online Threats



AGENDA

1. Understanding Phishing
2. Protection and Prevention
3. Learning and Applying



7/17/2026

UNDERSTANDING PHISHING



WHAT IS PHISHING AND WHY IT MATTERS

A digital con job

- Attackers impersonate trusted brands, coworkers, or friends
- Goal: steal passwords, money, or personal information

How it hooks you

- Uses urgency, fear, or curiosity to prompt quick clicks
- Often arrives via email, texts, DMs, or phone calls

Who gets targeted

- Individuals, schools, small businesses, and large organizations
- Anyone can be fooled, especially under time pressure

Why it matters

- One mistake can expose accounts and sensitive data
- Awareness plus habits reduces risk significantly over time

SPOTTING SUSPICIOUS EMAILS

Check the sender and tone

- Verify the full address; watch lookalike domains.
- Be wary of urgent threats or “act now” pressure.

Scan for quality red flags

- Typos, odd formatting, or mismatched logos are warning signs.
- Generic greetings like “Dear customer” raise suspicion.

Treat links and files as risky

- Hover to preview links; don’t trust the display text.
- Unexpected attachments (ZIP, DOC, PDF) can be dangerous.

Confirm before you comply

- Use a known phone number or official site to verify.
- Never send passwords or one-time codes by email.



RECOGNIZING FAKE LOGIN PAGES

Look for subtle mismatches

- Logo, colors, and layout slightly off from usual.
- Extra pop-ups demanding re-login or verification.

Verify the URL first

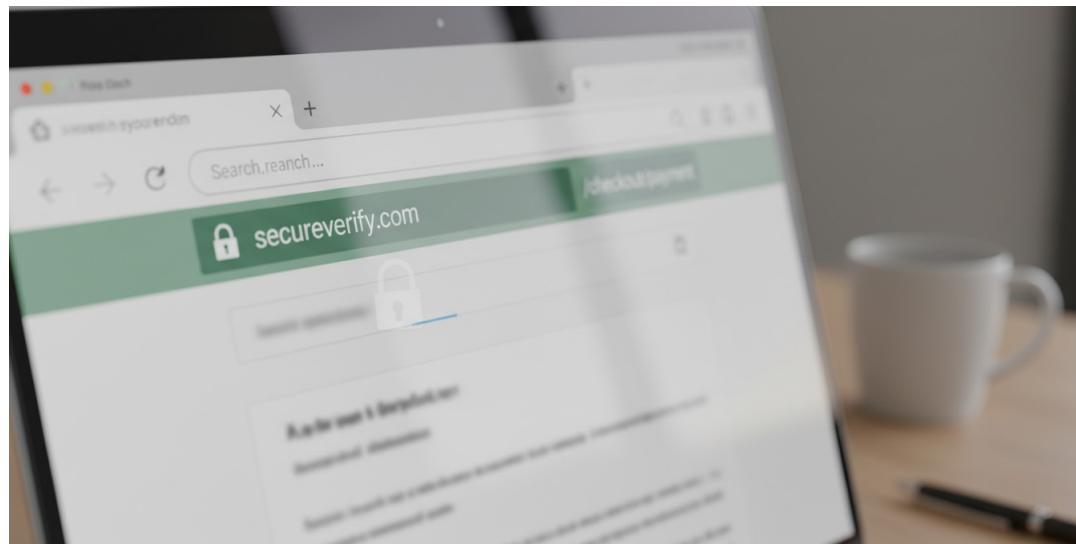
- Hover links; compare domain to the real site.
- Watch for misspellings, odd subdomains, or new TLDs.

Avoid credential traps

- Do not sign in from an email or text link.
- Type the site yourself or use a saved bookmark.



IDENTIFYING FRAUDULENT WEBSITES



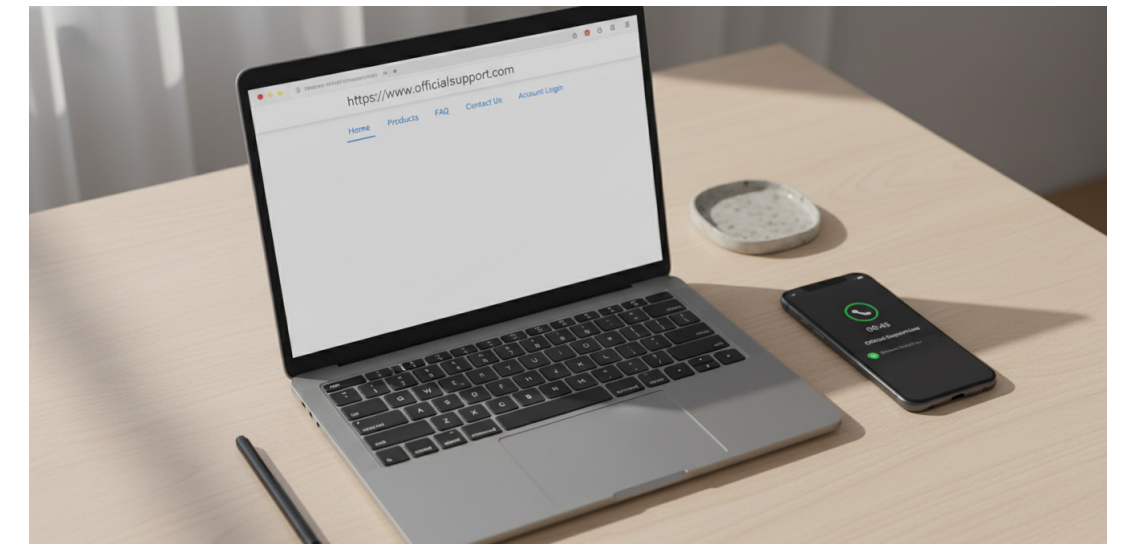
Check the connection

- Use **HTTPS**; avoid forms on plain HTTP pages.
- Padlock helps, but confirm the domain is correct.



Scan for quality red flags

- Poor design, broken links, and odd pop-ups signal risk.
- Watch for misspellings and mismatched logos or branding.



Verify before sharing info

- Type the site yourself; don't trust emailed links.
- Confirm via official contact methods before signing in.



SOCIAL ENGINEERING TRICKS EXPLAINED

Emotion-based pressure

- Urgency: “pay now” or “account closes in 24 hours”.
- Fear/curiosity: “suspicious login” or “see attached details”.

Impersonation

- Pretend to be IT, your bank, delivery, or a coworker.
- Lookalike names/domains: rn vs m, .co vs .com.

Common lures

- Fake invoices and overdue payment notices.
- Prize offers, refunds, or “verify your account” warnings.

Safer response

- Pause 10 seconds; verify via a known number or app.
- Do not reply; report the message to security.

PROTECTION AND PREVENTION





SECURITY TIPS TO STAY SAFE

Harden your accounts

- Use **unique passwords**; prefer a password manager for storage.
- Turn on **2FA** (authenticator app or security key).

Treat links and files as risky

- Hover to preview URLs; type the site yourself instead.
- Do not open unexpected attachments, especially ZIP or macros.

Keep devices and apps updated

- Enable auto-updates for OS, browser, and key apps.
- Run antivirus/anti-malware; scan weekly and after downloads.

Add quick safety checks

- Verify urgent requests via a second channel (call, chat).
- Report suspicious messages; deleting helps stop repeat attacks.

LEARNING AND APPLYING





CASE STUDIES AND REAL-LIFE EXAMPLES

Business email compromise (BEC)

- CEO spoof requests urgent wire transfer; finance complies.
- Prevent: call-back verification; **MFA**; payment approval limits.

Fake password reset page

- Email link opens lookalike login; credentials harvested silently.
- Prevent: type URL manually; check domain; password manager.

Delivery invoice attachment

- Unexpected “invoice” urges macros; malware installs in minutes.
- Prevent: block macros; scan attachments; report to IT/SOC.

Key lessons from incidents

- Attackers use urgency, authority, and “normal” business context.
- Pause 30 seconds; verify out-of-band before any action.



QUICK QUIZ: TEST YOUR KNOWLEDGE

Quiz 1: Email check

- Message says act in 10 minutes or account closes.
- Sender domain is slightly misspelled; link looks shortened.

Quiz 2: Login page check

- URL is not the real brand domain; extra words added.
- Page asks for password plus code; no normal sign-in route.

Choose the safest action

- A) Click link B) Reply C) Visit site by typing URL
- Correct: **C**. Then confirm using a known support channel.

Why these are phishing

- Red flags: urgency, spoofed sender, unusual URL, extra data requests.
- If unsure: report, delete, and change passwords if submitted.

KEY TAKEAWAYS AND NEXT STEPS



Pause and verify

- Question unexpected requests, especially urgent threats or rewards.
- Verify via trusted channels, not the email link.



Harden everyday security

- Use **unique passwords** and enable **two-factor authentication**.
- Update devices; use antivirus and browser protections.



Handle links and files safely

- Hover to preview URLs; type known addresses manually.
- Open attachments only when you expect them.



Strengthen your community

- Report suspicious messages to IT, providers, or the platform.
- Share examples and tips so others spot scams faster.